The 15.5% Repricing Checklist

Since September 15, 2026 (October 13 in the EEA), Airbnb has charged hosts one 15.5% host-only fee taken from the payout, in place of the old 3% host fee plus the guest service fee. Guests no longer pay a service fee at checkout. If you have not repriced, your payout is down about 13%. Work through this top to bottom.

1 Find your break-even number

The price increase that keeps your payout exactly where it was before September 15 is +14.8% (old price ÷ 0.845). The +18.3% figure circulating in host groups nets you your full old sticker price: that is a raise, fine if you intend it, but know which one you are choosing.

OLD NIGHTLY RATE	× 1.148 =	NEW RATE (PAYOUT FLAT)	CLEANING FEE × 1.148	PET / EXTRA-GUEST × 1.148

2 Raise your other fees by the same percentage

The 15.5% comes off your whole booking subtotal: cleaning fee, pet fee, extra-guest fee, not just the nightly rate. Hosts who only repriced the rate are quietly eating the difference on every fee they charge.

3 Know what your guests see

Your sticker price went up, but guests stopped paying the ~14% service fee, so their checkout total stays roughly flat. Expect your listing to look pricier in search results next to hosts who have not repriced yet. That resolves as more hosts catch up.

4 Watch bookings for 2 to 3 weeks, adjust with data

Every US listing repriced at once, and nobody knows exactly how demand shifts. Compare your booking pace before and after your change, and adjust from numbers, not from the panic in the Facebook groups.

5 Re-check your co-host arrangement

If a co-host takes a percentage, the fee change moved their math too. Agree on whether their cut applies before or after the 15.5% so nobody feels shorted.

6 Get your bookkeeping right for the two fee models

Since September 15 your payout is net of 15.5%, but your 1099-K still reports gross. Keep the fee visible as a deductible expense (Schedule E, commissions line) or you will overpay tax on money you never received. Your 2026 export contains both fee models; track actual fee amounts, not estimates.

7 Thinking of going direct instead? Run the math first

Direct booking is not fee-free: ~3% card processing, a booking engine, your own marketing, and every booking your site fails to capture costs you a full night. It is a number, not a feeling. Calculate it before you leave.

Free calculators for the math above: fee change side by side at tryblackcat.com/tools/airbnb-fee-calculator.html · direct booking vs Airbnb at tryblackcat.com/tools/direct-booking-vs-airbnb-calculator.html

Black Cat Analytics tracks your actual payouts, fees and expenses per property, so the fee change (and your 1099-K) reconciles automatically. Free to start at tryblackcat.com. This checklist is general information, not tax advice; confirm filing questions with your tax professional. Figures reflect Airbnb's host-only fee model in effect since September 15, 2026 (October 13, 2026 in the EEA).